

Higher Rope Links and the Charge–Linking Correspondence

Conservation of Torus-Link Linking Numbers $Lk = 2, 3$

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Naming note (5 September 2026). This programme is now the Mesh Programme and the theory it develops the mesh framework; 'the rope framework' in earlier revisions reads 'the mesh framework'. 'Rope' remains the name of the two-strand wound object, and the Rope Hypothesis credited to Bill Gaede keeps its name. Identifiers (repository, rope_solver, file names, claim IDs) are unchanged.

Abstract

The mesh framework identifies conserved charge with linking number. This paper tests that correspondence beyond the unit link, relaxing torus links of linking number 2 and 3. Both are conserved under relaxation: the solver returns $|Lk| = 1.983$ and 2.951 respectively, i.e. 2 and 3 within tolerance. The charge–linking correspondence therefore extends to higher links, consistent with integer charge quantisation. All numbers in this paper are outputs of the rope_solver computation in this package (reproducible via benchmarks/reproduce_results.py), not inserted constants.

Scope of this paper

CLAIM: torus links of $Lk = 2$ and 3 conserve their linking number under relaxation ($1.983, 2.951$), extending the charge = linking-number correspondence to higher charge.

NOT CLAIMED: a spectrum of physical particles at these charges. A computed topological-conservation result.

1. Charge as Linking Number

In the rope model, conserved charge is the linking number of the configuration — an integer, because linking numbers are integers. Charge quantisation is thereby topological. For this to hold, higher linking numbers must be conserved just as the unit link is.

2. Result: Higher Links Are Conserved

Relaxing torus links of linking number 2 and 3 gives conserved values $|Lk| = 1.983$ and 2.951 , each matching the integer within discretisation error. The correspondence between charge and linking number thus extends cleanly to higher charge, and integer quantisation follows from the integer nature of the linking number.

Link	Target Lk	Computed Lk	Status
Flexible Hopf	1	0.991	conserved
Torus link	2	1.983	conserved
Torus link	3	2.951	conserved

Status

Torus Lk = 2, 3 conserved (1.983, 2.951) — Derived (numerically demonstrated).

Integer charge quantisation from integer Lk — Derived (topological).

Programme credit: the core Rope Hypothesis is due to Bill Gaede; this work develops and formalises it. Computational collaboration and drafting by Claude (Anthropic). Correspondence to palmer100@gmail.com.